

Following the Tech Rainbow



“It is necessary for us to be more realistic about what we expect from technology”

Every new piece of technology that comes to the fore today claims to be able to improve our lives for the better. It promises to increase our productivity levels with greater speed, the quality of our work through greater intelligence, and eventually promises a complete transformation of our lives.

Quite obviously this isn't something that is always true. However, this is something that we seem to have grown to expect.

But is this expectation realistic? Or are we now just willing to accept any pipe dream that is dressed as a technological advancement?

Has the technology that lies within each of our desktops today actually improved the quality of work that we are producing? And do we now really have more time to devote to our hobbies, friends and personal lives outside our workplace?

Many of us feel the need to upgrade to the latest version of applications like Microsoft Word but many choose to ignore something as basic as the Template functions in existing versions that could help us to organise ourselves better? Or the Commenting feature which can make collaboration between people who share documents so much easier. We use software like Microsoft Outlook as an e-mail client, but choose to completely ignore the contact and time management utilities, filtering features and the unified messaging platform that it provides.

To really unleash the potential of technology, it is necessary for us to be more realistic about what we expect from it. We need to look at it as something that can create opportunities, instead of expecting a magical packaged solution to all our problems. Technology can help make our tasks easier, but it is too much to expect it to provide us with a replacement for intelligence.

We need to look for smarter ways to utilise the technology that is already available to us.

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